



GRADE 10
ENGLISH OLYMPIAD

National Level Examination (NLE) 2026

SUBJECT CODE			
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Total Questions: 50

Total Marks: 50

Time: 75 Minutes

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED TO DO SO

- Carefully Check Your Name, Class, Roll Number, And Other Required Details On The OMR Answer Sheet.
- Do Not Forget To Sign The OMR Sheet. Also Write Your Roll No. On The Question Paper Booklet.
- Use Only Black/Blue Ball Pen And HB Pencil To Fill The OMR Answer Sheet.
- All Questions Are Compulsory And Carry One Mark Each.
- Section A: Grammar (10 Questions); Section B: Vocabulary (10 Questions); Section C: Reading Comprehension (10 Questions); Section D: Writing Skills (10 Questions); Section E: Excellence Zone (10 Questions).
- Only OMR Answer Sheets Will Be Evaluated.
- No Negative Marking For Incorrect Answers.
- You May Use The Space Provided On The Last Page For Rough Work (If Needed).
- Digital Devices Like Calculators, Smart Watches, Or Mobile Phones Are Not Allowed.
- After The Exam, Submit Both The OMR Sheet And The Question Paper To The Invigilator.

SECTION A – GRAMMAR**Q1. Choose the option closest in meaning:**

"Hardly had he stepped out when it began to rain."
 A. No sooner did he step out than it began to rain.
 B. As soon as he stepped out, it began to rain.
 C. He stepped out after it had begun to rain.
 D. Scarcely he stepped out when it began to rain.

Q2. Read the sentence carefully:

Original: People say that she is the best singer.
 Student's answer: She is said that she is the best singer.
 The student's answer is:
 A. Completely correct
 B. Acceptable in informal usage
 C. Grammatically incorrect
 D. Structurally ambiguous

Q3. Which pair shares identical deep structure?

A. What he did shocked everyone. / What she said annoyed me.
 B. The man who is standing there. / Because he was late.
 C. If you call me. / That he was honest.
 D. Running fast is healthy. / The boy playing outside.

Q4. Choose the most accurate transformation:

"Unless you improve, you will fail."
 A. If you do not improve, you will fail.
 B. If you will not improve, you fail.
 C. Without improving, you will fail.
 D. If you do not improve, you would fail.

Q5. Arrange from strongest to weakest logical possibility (not permission):

1. could
 2. must
 3. might
 4. may
 A. 2-4-1-3
 B. 2-1-4-3
 C. 4-2-3-1
 D. 1-3-4-2

Q6. Identify the redundancy:

"Although he was inexperienced, yet he managed the task efficiently."
 Which word must be removed?
 A. Although
 B. Yet
 C. Inexperienced
 D. Efficiently

Q7. Logical equivalence question:

I. None of the students has submitted the project.
 II. Not any of the students have submitted the project.
 A. Both correct and equivalent
 B. Both correct but not equivalent
 C. Only I is correct
 D. Only II is correct

Q8. A teacher said to the students,

"Why have you not completed your assignment? Submit it by tomorrow without fail." Which of the following is the correct indirect form?
 A. The teacher asked the students why they had not completed their assignment and told them to submit it by the next day without fail.
 B. The teacher asked the students why they have not completed their assignment and ordered them to submit it by tomorrow.
 C. The teacher asked the students why had they not completed their assignment and told them to submit it by tomorrow without fail.
 D. The teacher asked the students why they had not completed their assignment and said to submit it by the next day.

Q9. Choose the correct passive transformation:

"They made the players follow the new rules strictly."
 A. The players were made follow the new rules strictly.
 B. The players were made to follow the new rules strictly.
 C. The players were made to be followed the new rules strictly.
 D. The players made to follow the new rules strictly.

Q10. By the time she reached the station, the train ____.

A. left
 B. has left
 C. had left
 D. was leaving

SECTION B – VOCABULARY**Q1. Choose the correct analogy:**

Ephemeral: Permanent:: Obscure : ____
 A. Hidden
 B. Clear
 C. Vague
 D. Doubtful

Q2. The idiom "to miss the boat" means:

A. To miss an opportunity
 B. To travel late
 C. To avoid responsibility
 D. To lose direction

Q3. A person who deliberately sets fire to property:

A. Arsonist
 B. Terrorist
 C. Assassin
 D. Saboteur

Q4. The manager decided to call off the meeting.

A. postpone
 B. cancel
 C. continue
 D. arrange

Q5. Which collocation is most appropriate?

A. Make a crime
 B. Commit a crime
 C. Do a crime
 D. Perform a crime

Q6. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank.

The phrase "to gild the lily" means ____.
 (A) to decorate something already beautiful unnecessarily
 (B) to revive something old with effort
 (C) to hide imperfections cleverly
 (D) to make something more valuable

Q7. Choose the correct option to fill in the blank.

She has a tendency to ____ facts to suit her narrative.
 (A) obfuscate
 (B) embellish
 (C) obliterate
 (D) extenuate

Q8. Choose the option with the correct spelling.

A word meaning "incapable of being tired out":
 (A) Indefatigable
 (B) Indefatigible
 (C) Indifatuigable
 (D) Indefatiguable

Q9. Choose the correct meaning of the underlined idiom.

He decided to throw in the towel after several failed attempts.
 (A) To clean up a mess
 (B) To give up
 (C) To start afresh
 (D) To protest strongly

Q10. Arrange the words from weakest to strongest intensity:

1. Content
 2. Ecstatic
 3. Happy
 4. Delighted
 A. 1, 3, 4, 2
 B. 3, 1, 4, 2
 C. 1, 4, 3, 2
 D. 3, 4, 1, 2

SECTION C – READING COMPREHENSION

Q1. Direction: Read the passage carefully and answer the questions.

In contemporary discourse, information is often equated with understanding, as though accumulation alone guarantees insight. Yet, an excess of information can paradoxically obscure clarity. When individuals are confronted with constant streams of data, the ability to prioritise, interpret and synthesise becomes increasingly compromised. In such conditions, knowledge risks fragmentation, reduced to disconnected facts rather than integrated meaning. This phenomenon is further complicated by the illusion of comprehension. Familiarity with information—through repeated exposure—can create a false sense of mastery. However, recognition is not equivalent to understanding. True comprehension requires deliberate engagement: questioning assumptions, identifying relationships and constructing coherent frameworks. Thus, the challenge of the modern age is not access to information but the discipline to transform it into knowledge. Without this transformation, individuals may remain informed yet fundamentally uninformed.

1A. Which statement best captures the central tension presented in the passage?

- A. Information is more valuable than understanding
- B. Excess information may hinder meaningful understanding
- C. Knowledge depends entirely on memory
- D. Understanding eliminates the need for information

1B. The phrase “illusion of comprehension” suggests that:

- A. People completely misunderstand all information
- B. Familiarity can be mistaken for true understanding
- C. Information is always misleading
- D. Understanding is impossible to achieve

1C. Which assumption is most essential to the author’s argument?

- A. Access to information is limited
- B. Understanding requires active cognitive effort
- C. Information is inherently unreliable
- D. Memory is more important than reasoning

1D. What is the author’s implicit critique of modern learning habits?

- A. They focus excessively on memorisation without integration
- B. They discourage exposure to information
- C. They rely too heavily on traditional methods
- D. They ignore technological tools

1E. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the author’s argument?

- A. People can understand concepts without questioning them
- B. Increased information always leads to deeper insight
- C. Structured learning improves synthesis of information
- D. Familiarity enhances long-term retention

Q2. Direction: Read the passage carefully and answer the questions.

Ambition is often celebrated as a driving force behind achievement, yet its nature is rarely examined critically. When directed towards meaningful goals, ambition can foster perseverance and innovation. However, when detached from ethical considerations or intrinsic purpose, it risks becoming self-consuming, prioritising success over significance.

A distinction must therefore be drawn between ambition as aspiration and ambition as compulsion. The former is guided by values and reflection, while the latter is driven by comparison and external validation. In environments where success is narrowly defined—often in terms of status or recognition—individuals may pursue goals that are misaligned with their deeper convictions.

The consequence is not merely personal dissatisfaction but a broader erosion of integrity in collective systems. Sustainable achievement, therefore, requires not the abandonment of ambition but its redefinition.

2A. Which idea forms the core argument of the passage?

- A. Ambition is inherently harmful
- B. Ambition must be guided by values to remain meaningful
- C. Success depends only on external recognition
- D. Ambition and ethics cannot coexist

2B. The distinction between “aspiration” and “compulsion” primarily highlights:

- A. The difference between success and failure
- B. The role of internal vs external motivation
- C. The importance of competition
- D. The need for social approval

2C. What is the likely consequence of “narrow definitions of success”?

- A. Increased creativity
- B. Stronger personal values
- C. Misalignment between goals and personal beliefs
- D. Reduction in ambition

2D. The author’s tone can best be described as:

- A. Neutral and descriptive
- B. Critical yet constructive
- C. Emotional and biased
- D. Sarcastic

2E. Which situation best illustrates the author’s viewpoint?

- A. A student chooses a career solely based on salary despite lack of interest
- B. A student works hard to achieve academic excellence
- C. A student avoids competition entirely
- D. A student follows instructions carefully

SECTION D – WRITING SKILLS

Q1. Analyze the opening and choose the continuation that introduces the most layered conflict:

The award I had worked for all year was finally in my hands but something felt profoundly wrong.

- A. I smiled and thanked everyone politely.
- B. I realised the project I submitted was not entirely my own work.
- C. The stage lights were too bright to see clearly.
- D. My parents looked proud in the audience.

Q2. Select the most nuanced and debatable thesis for an article on “Social Media and Identity”:

- A. Social media is widely used today.
- B. Social media affects people’s lives.
- C. Social media simultaneously enables self-expression and reinforces performative identities shaped by external validation.
- D. Social media is entertaining.

Q3. Choose the sentence that best completes the argument logically:

Merit-based systems are often considered fair because they reward ability and effort. However, this assumption overlooks structural inequalities. _____. Therefore, outcomes may reflect privilege as much as performance.

- A. Everyone should work hard to succeed.
- B. Access to resources and opportunities is unevenly distributed.
- C. Competition motivates individuals.
- D. Success requires determination.

Q4. Identify the sentence that would most effectively strengthen a formal complaint letter:

- A. This situation is very bad and annoying.
- B. I kindly request you to look into the matter.
- C. I urge the authorities to take immediate action to address the recurring disruption, which has significantly affected residents.
- D. Something must be done quickly.

Q5. Choose the statement that demonstrates the highest level of reflection:

Today’s experience forced me to reconsider what success truly means.

- A. The event was well organised.
- B. I now understand that external achievements without personal integrity lack lasting value.
- C. Many people attended the event.
- D. It ended on time.

Q6. Select the most logically appropriate transition:

Technological innovation has revolutionised communication. _____, it has also introduced complex ethical challenges regarding data privacy.

- A. Similarly
- B. Consequently
- C. Nevertheless
- D. For instance

Q7. Match the writing purpose with the most appropriate form:

- 1. Critical evaluation of a social issue
- 2. Personal emotional introspection
- 3. Formal grievance submission
- P. Diary Entry
- Q. Formal Letter
- R. Article
- A. 1–R, 2–P, 3–Q
- B. 1–Q, 2–R, 3–P
- C. 1–P, 2–Q, 3–R
- D. 1–R, 2–Q, 3–P

Q8. Select the most effective and arguable topic sentence:

- A. Education is important for everyone.
- B. Schools play a role in society.
- C. Education systems must prioritise critical thinking over rote learning to prepare students for complex real-world challenges.
- D. Students study many subjects and importance should be given to practical knowledge over theoretical learning

SECTION D – WRITING SKILL

Q9. Choose the best revision of the underlined phrase:

"The new policy created a lot of problems for small businesses."

- A. many bad situations
- B. several issues
- C. significant operational challenges
- D. different kinds of problems

Q10. Which paragraph demonstrates the strongest argumentative structure?

- A. "Pollution is harmful. Many people know this. It should be reduced."
- B. "Pollution affects health. Governments should act."
- C. "Rising pollution levels are not merely environmental concerns but public health crises necessitating coordinated policy interventions."
- D. "Pollution is increasing in cities and measures should be taken to tackle them at the earliest."

SECTION E – EXCELLENCE ZONE

Q1. A survey was conducted in a class of 40 students regarding their preferred reading genre:

Genre.	Number of Students
Fiction.	12
Non-fiction.	10
Mystery.	8
Science.	6
Poetry.	4

Based on the data, which of the following statements is grammatically correct AND logically accurate?

- A. A number of students prefers fiction over other genres.
- B. The number of students who prefers fiction are highest.
- C. The number of students who prefer fiction is the highest.
- D. A number of students prefer fiction is highest.

Q2. Online education is more effective than traditional classrooms.

Which option strengthens this argument the most?

- A. Many students prefer online learning.
- B. Online platforms allow personalised pacing and access to various resources.
- C. Traditional classrooms are still widely used but education is more effective and illustrious in online education.
- D. Some students face internet issues.

Q3. All poets are dreamers. Some dreamers are philosophers.

Which conclusion is definitely correct?

- A. All philosophers are poets
- B. Some poets are philosophers
- C. Some dreamers may not be poets
- D. All dreamers are poets

Q4. Skeptic : Doubt :: Optimist : ?

- A. Belief
- B. Hope
- C. Trust
- D. Faith

Q5. Assertion (A): All effective communication requires clarity.

Reason (R): Ambiguity can lead to multiple interpretations.

- A. Both A and R are true and R explains A
- B. Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- C. A is true, R is false
- D. A is false, R is true

Q6. Identify the odd one out.

- A. Hypothesis
- B. Assumption
- C. Conclusion
- D. Evidence

Q7. If THINK → UJKOL, then how will BRAIN be coded?

- A. CSBJO
- B. DSBKP
- C. CSBKP
- D. DRBJO

Q8. Identify the correct sentence with proper inversion and agreement.

- A. No sooner the results were announced than chaos erupted.
- B. No sooner had the results been announced than chaos erupted.
- C. No sooner had the results announced than chaos erupted.
- D. No sooner had been the results announced than chaos erupted.

Q9. A logician states:

"All sustainable solutions are scalable. Some scalable solutions are not affordable."

Which conclusion logically follows?

- A. Some sustainable solutions are not affordable.
- B. All affordable solutions are sustainable.
- C. Some scalable solutions may be sustainable.
- D. No sustainable solution is affordable.

Q10. Identify the incorrectly spelt word.

- A. Conscientious
- B. Occurrence
- C. Priviledge
- D. Maintenance